

Roelof van der Merwe

Roelof van der Merwe is no stranger to World Cups. The 2026 T20 World Cup will be the veteran Dutch all-rounder's seventh trip to cricket's biggest stage, having represented both South Africa and the Netherlands at T20 and ODI World Cups.

The all-rounder first represented South Africa in 2009, featuring in its 2009 T20 World Cup campaign. He went on to play 26 times for the Proteas across ODIs and T20Is, taking 31 wickets and scoring 96 runs.

After falling out of international contention, van der Merwe opted to represent the Netherlands. He has since established himself as a consistent performer for the Flying Dutchmen, representing them 80 times across formats, taking 88 wickets and scoring 743 runs. During this period, he also established himself as a fixture in English First-Class cricket with Somerset.

The 41-year-old tweaker also brings a wealth of franchise experience, having featured in the IPL (Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Delhi Capitals), the SA20 (Sunrisers Eastern Cape), the ILT20 (Dubai Capitals), the CPL (Barbados Royals and St Lucia Kings) and The Hundred (London Spirit, Northern Superchargers and Welsh Fire).



Dipendra Singh Airee



Nepal went winless at the 2024 T20 World Cup and will be hoping to change that in 2026. If it does, much of the responsibility will rest on the experience and all-round influence of vice-captain Dipendra Singh Airee. An all-rounder in the truest sense, Airee packs a punch with his ball-striking through the middle overs, bowls useful off-spin, and is a gun fielder with a penchant for acrobatic heroics.

He has also made a habit of rewriting Nepal's record books. Airee has represented his country 90 times in the shortest format, and the 1,956 runs he has amassed at an average of 32.06 make him Nepal's most prolific T20I batter. The 58 wickets he has picked up also place him fifth on the country's all-time wicket-takers' list.

He holds two further records. At the 2022 Asian Games in Hangzhou, he smashed the fastest fifty in T20 history — off just nine balls — against Mongolia in an innings that featured eight sixes. He is also one of only three men, alongside Yuvraj Singh and Kieron Pollard, to hit six sixes in an over, a feat he achieved against Kamran Khan of Qatar during the 2024 ACC Men's Premier Cup.

